

New Testament





About the Course

Each year, students in Grades 3-6 read one of the gospels. For 2026-2027, they read John. Lesson plans include map work and assigned selections of The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times for teachers to read with their students before or after Bible reading to help give context and insight into the culture and geography of Israel during Jesus' life.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grade 3, Bible: Grades 4-6



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for older students if combining lessons, and ideal for older students just getting familiar with the Bible.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6 2 times/week 20 min	ESV Large Print Bible The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 3				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 1-3
Bible: Grades 4-6				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 4-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grades 3-6



ESV Large Print Bible



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)
- ∞ [How can we find the original meaning of the text?](#)
- ∞ [How do we help students learn to interpret the Bible?](#)
- ∞ [How does learning about the Ancient Near East world help us understand the Bible?](#)
- ∞ [What is the role of the Holy Spirit when reading the Bible?](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



New Testament: Grades 3-6

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Read

- Read the chapter or selection aloud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the students' pace during the lesson, rather than feeling that a particular number of pages must be completed. It is vitally important that teachers not overload students with more material than they can absorb in one sitting.
- Students who have difficulty sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Students with regular difficulty engaging often benefit from having a picture to associate with the story WHILE listening. Feel free to view the artwork during the reading rather than after the narration.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



View

- Optional: Share a piece of fine art that illustrates the story.



Discuss

- Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
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SAMPLE

New Testament: Grades 3-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 1

Intro to the Gospel of John

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

PREP:

Teachers may wish to view the Bible Project video covering the first half of the book of John in preparation for teaching.

∞ Video Link: Bible Project: Book of John (First Half)

→ INTRO

This year in New Testament we will be reading from the gospel of John. The four gospels—Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John all tell about the life of Christ. They each bring a unique perspective. John demonstrates that Jesus is the Son of God (not just a man) who came to earth to reveal the Father and to bring eternal life to all who believe in him. The most famous verse in the Bible comes from John. Do you know what verse that is? (John 3:16)

The John who wrote the book is one of the twelve disciples who followed Jesus closely throughout his ministry on earth. He also wrote the books of First, Second, Third John, and the book of Revelation.

The book of John was written somewhere between 85-95 AD, which makes it the last of the four gospels written. In his gospel, John includes some details that the others left out and skips over some events that the other three gospel writers included. He writes to both Jews and Gentiles. (A Gentile is anyone who is not Jewish.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Today, we will look at a few verses to set a foundation for our reading this year and to find out a little bit about who John was.

We do not have to guess why John wanted to write his gospel, because he states his purpose very clearly.

Read John 20:30-31.

- Why does John say he wrote his gospel?

Read John 13:23; 20:2; 21:7, 20.

- How does John speak about himself in relation to Jesus?

Read Matthew 4:18-22; Mark 3:13-21.

- How do the gospel authors Matthew and Mark refer to John?

→ NOTEBOOK

As you read through the book of John, you will keep a notebook. Today, you will begin this notebook by making a title page.

On your title page, write the name of the book, the author, and the approximate date the book was written, 85-95 AD. On your title page, copy down John 20:30-31, the verses stating the purpose of the book. (Students may write as little or as much as time and ability allow. You could also take time to complete this task in lesson 2, if needed.)

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 2

The Word Was God

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook (optional)

NOTE: Today's lesson has a video that is a helpful explanation of the opening of John's gospel. Although some of the concepts may be a bit intricate for younger students, the overall look at this passage gives



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helpful context to John's opening words.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read about last time about the introduction to the book of John?

→ INTRO

Instead of starting with the birth of Jesus or with the story of John the Baptist, as the other three gospels do, John begins his gospel by showing that Jesus is the Son of God and is 100% God and 100% human. The book of John starts with "In the beginning." This reminds us of Genesis 1:1, the very first verse of the Bible, which begins with the exact same phrase: In the beginning.

Also, in today's reading, another man named John the Baptist is mentioned. These are two separate individuals with the same name. John, the author, tells us what the role of John the Baptist was.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:1-13

→ VIEW & NARRATE

Watch the video for an overview and explanation of John 1.

∞ Video Link: John 1

→ NOTEBOOK (OPTIONAL)

If additional time was needed to copy down verse 20:30-31, you may complete that today.

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 3

The Word Dwelt Among Us

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:14-27

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: What does it mean that the Word dwelt among us?

For younger students: Begin with the fourth paragraph "Not only did the Word" - end.

Older students: Read the entire answer starting with "In John 1:14."

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students may draw a picture of what we have read so far in John or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or write down what they have learned about Jesus dwelling, or being "tabernacled," among us.

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 4

Behold!

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

The next verses continue speaking about John the Baptist and his testimony regarding his baptizing of Jesus. He testifies to Jesus, and the people who hear him begin following Jesus. As the Bible Project states,



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"One by one as people encounter Jesus, they say out loud who they think he is. In this one chapter, Jesus is given seven titles: the Lamb of God, Son of God, Rabbi, Messiah, King of Israel, Jesus of Nazareth, and the Son of Man."

Today, we will begin a list of the titles people give when they see Jesus, and in our next reading, we will read the rest of these titles. These seven titles claim Jesus as the Messiah and Savior of the world.

In the passage, we also see Jesus call his first two disciples. In New Testament times, it was not unusual for Rabbis—or Teachers—to have disciples who would follow and learn from these teachers.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:28-39

- As Simon Peter and Andrew did, what would it be like to drop everything and begin following Jesus as his disciple?

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students, draw a picture either of John the Baptist speaking about Jesus OR of Simon Peter and Andrew following after Jesus. Older students may write a summary or begin a list of the seven names given to Jesus in this chapter. (The three from today's reading would be: Lamb of God, Rabbi (Teacher), and Messiah (Christ).) Write the name and the verse reference where the title is found.

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 5

Philip and Nathanael are Called

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:40-51

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students may add on to the picture of Simon Peter and Andrew following Jesus by adding Philip and Nathanael, OR they may write a short summary of the passage. Older students, continue your list of titles or names that Jesus is given by those who behold him. Include the reference where each title is found. (The titles from today's reading would be: Jesus of Nazareth, Son of God, King of Israel, Son of Man.)

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 6

Wedding at Cana

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

John's gospel includes signs to point to Jesus as Messiah. These miracles (signs) are contained in the first few chapters of the book, and some refer to chapters 1-12 as "The Book of Signs." In John's purpose statement for his gospel, he stated that Jesus did many signs during his ministry on earth, and these miracles or signs are included so that people would believe Jesus was the Messiah (John 20:30-31). In other words, these signs were pointing to who Jesus is. Today's reading will include the first of these signs.



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→ READ & NARRATE

John 2:1-12

Weddings often went on for seven days, and frequently the best wine would be served at the beginning, with the less expensive (not as good) wine being held to the last. However, when they taste the wine Jesus has provided, it is much better than even the expensive wine! Jesus as the Creator is shown through this miracle. And, even today, we see that God uses rain to water the vineyards to grow the grapes to turn into wine in the "agricultural and fermentation processes. Here He simply did the process immediately." (The Bible Knowledge Commentary)

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: The Marriage at Cana by Paolo Veronese

- What do you notice about this painting of how the artist depicted the wedding at Cana?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn in your notebook to a blank page (you may want to leave space for 2 pages if writing or 3-4 pages if the student will be drawing), where we will begin to create a list of the signs John includes in his gospel. Younger students: Begin your list with the number 1. Either write down a summary phrase (i.e., Jesus turns water into wine at the wedding) or draw a picture to show what the first sign is. Older students may title their list, and under 1., write down a summary phrase, verse reference, and description of what Jesus' first miracle was.